

Journey Map Written Reflection

Marc Andre Lam

1. Where in the journey does the system feel most fragile?

The system feels most fragile when the journalist is between two stakeholders. For instance, they might be gathering information from anonymous sources in Brazil, then bringing that to their publisher before the story goes live. The publisher has to vet the information that the journalist has received, as according to [The Guardian](#) themselves, they have an extensive process for deeming information trustworthy:

Do not state as fact information about or from someone who we cannot authenticate (eg, 'A student who says she witnessed the riot', not 'A student who witnessed the riot'). Where relevant we must be open with readers in saying what medium was used to conduct an interview. Satisfaction with sources is the responsibility of desk editors as well as reporters and correspondents

If a journalist is publishing a story about the relations between stakeholders in Brazil's biogas industry, they must then be able to effectively confirm and authenticate their information.

2. Which stakeholders have the most influence?

Editors and publishers have the most influence, as they are the ones who ultimately determine whether the story gets out. However, the general public also has influence, as their stories may get out one way or another regarding a certain topic. If readers at *The Guardian* want to know about a developing news story, logic follows that *The Guardian* will seek to meet that demand with reporting.

3. What repeated patterns or tensions did you observe?

A pattern I noticed was that most of the issues in reporting a story come down to communication with stakeholders. Understanding how to translate a story or report from a source into something that readers can comprehend, whilst complying with publishers, is at the heart of many tensions.

4. Before designing anything beyond a concept, what would you want to investigate further?

I'd like to investigate further the ways in which trust can be formed between these stakeholders. At the end of the day, good journalism is built on trust between the reader and the writer's work, so I want to see how that can be established throughout the journey.

Sources:

1. <https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2015/jul/06/how-the-guardian-decides-which-sources-can-be-deemed-trustworthy>
2. <https://reutersinstitute.politics.ox.ac.uk/other-side-how-identity-shapes-local-coverage-violent-conflict#:~:text=Language%20is%20a%20powerful%20tool,separatists%2C%20terrorists%20or%20freedom%20fighters.>
3. <https://www.ebsco.com/research-starters/communication-and-mass-media/high-context-and-low-context-cultures>
4. <https://www.globalcitizen.org/en/content/silenced-brazil-journalism-environment-ifpim/>